

James F. Lawson

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Professional Summary

DevOps/Infrastructure specialist with 3 years+ building and shipping production systems. Deep hands-on experience with Prometheus, GCP and Ansible, most recently at Datadog.

Academic History

High School

Perrymouth High School | 2019 - 2022

Professional Experience

Datadog — Infrastructure Engineer

08/2022 - 03/2026

- Designed the multi-region failover strategy and led the game-day exercises that proved it.
- Led the Kubernetes upgrade across 10 clusters with zero customer-visible downtime.
- Hardened Prometheus environments ahead of SOC 2, closing 2 critical findings.
- Wrote the platform team's paved-road documentation, cutting onboarding from weeks to days.

Key Skills

Prometheus | GCP | Ansible | Redis | Postman | Redshift

Selected Projects

Recipe search engine

Full-text search over a scraped recipe corpus using Postman; learned more about ranking than about cooking.

Training & Certifications

Databricks Certified Data Engineer Associate — Databricks, 2026

Selected Publications

"Cache coherence under bursty workloads" - co-authored conference paper, 2023.

"Scheduling strategies for distributed task queues" - co-authored conference paper, 2022.

Languages

English – C2

References available upon request.